

# How is it solved today?

Your user already has ways to deal with this. Map them, see where you fit, and find what you are assuming.

# Two reasons to map the field.

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## THINK LIKE YOUR USER

### See how they choose.

When you can see every option your user already has, you start to understand how they decide. That is the choice your idea has to win.

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## FIND WHAT YOU ASSUME

### See what you are betting on.

Once you can see where you fit, you can see the things you are taking for granted. Those are what you go and check.

# Meet Tomás. He wants to play guitar.

We follow one real person the whole way through.

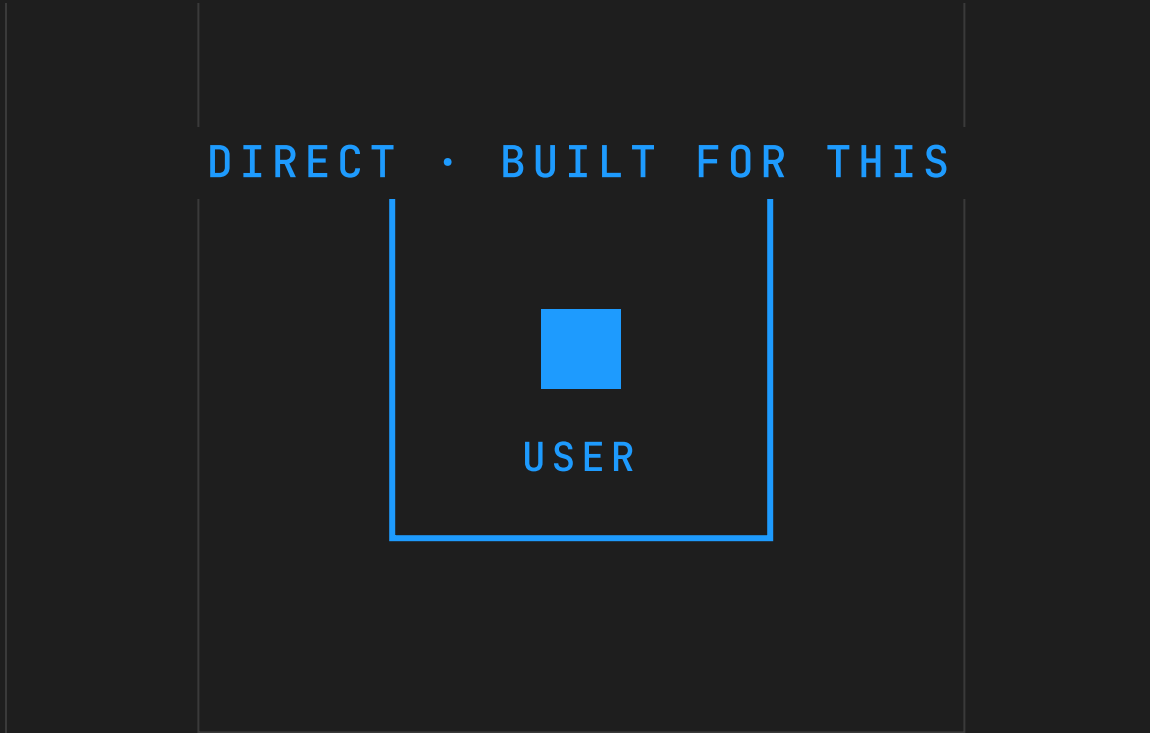
## HIS 7PM

Most nights at 7pm his guitar stays in its case. He means to practise, and instead he picks up his phone, and it stays shut until bedtime.

# How the problem gets solved today.

Your user already has ways to cope. They sit in three rings around them.

ON T INDIRECT • THE WORKAROUNDS / DO



# Tomás's options, ring by ring.

## DIRECT

### **Apps built for learning guitar.**

Cheap and structured, but he has to make himself open them.

## INDIRECT

### **Free videos, or paying a tutor.**

Videos are free but easy to drift from. A tutor keeps him going but costs money and time.

## ON HIS OWN

### **Guitar tuned, on its stand, lessons paid.**

Everything is ready. What is left is whether he picks it up at 7pm.



# How does Tomás choose?

No option is simply good or bad. Each one suits some people, in some moments.

## HOW HE DECIDES

Tomás has gone for free and flexible, so he leans on videos and his own willpower. That gives him freedom, and it leaves nobody keeping him going at 7pm. To see where you fit, weigh the options the way he does.

# Which option does Tomás lean on, and where does it let him down?

You are here as the market specialists. Say your answer to the group, then we lay it out and check it together.

SAY IT ALOUD • THEN CHECK

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# To compare the options, ask two questions.

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## QUESTION ONE

### How much does it help?

Does it really get Tomás keeping at it, or does it only help a little?

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## QUESTION TWO

### What does it ask of him?

His time, his money, and his willpower. The more an option asks, the sooner he drops it.



# Plot the options by help and effort.

The open spot is top right: a lot of help while asking little of him. That is where a new idea could sit.

|                                                       |                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| GUITAR ON A<br>STAND<br>ASKS LITTLE ·<br>HELPS LITTLE | OPEN SPOT<br>ASKS LITTLE ·<br>HELPS A LOT |
| FREE VIDEOS<br>ASKS A LOT ·<br>HELPS LITTLE           | A TUTOR<br>ASKS A LOT ·<br>HELPS A LOT    |

# Two ways a grid can mislead you.

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## PICK AXES THAT MATTER

### Use what your user trades.

If the two sides are not things your user really weighs, every option lands in a heap and you learn nothing.

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## AN OPEN SPOT IS NOT A PRIZE

### Ask why it is open.

Sometimes nobody has served it yet. Sometimes it is open because it cannot work. Part of your job is to find out which.

## A solution would sound like this.

You have not built it yet. This is the shape the open spot calls for.

**We give *your user* real help while asking *little of them*, where today's options *force a trade-off*.**

FOR TOMÁS, IT WOULD SOUND LIKE

We help Tomás keep playing, without a tutor's cost or the willpower a video demands.

# Your position rests on assumptions.

An assumption is something you believe is true but have not yet checked.

- 01 The block. What beats Tomás is sticking with it past the first week.
- 02 The fix. An app could give him the push a tutor gives, and he would take it.
- 03 The trade. He would rather pay little than buy a tutor's depth.

# Your turn.

Plotting the field helps you see where you sit, say it clearly, and check what you are assuming.

## MAP

**How your user solves  
it today.**

From your own head.

## LOOK

**Go through the real  
options.**

Where each works  
and fails.

## PLOT

**Place them, and  
place you.**

Read where you sit.

## NAME

**Your position, and  
what it rests on.**

Your assumptions.



# Map the field from your own head.

List the three rings as you understand them now, with no looking up yet.

|                                                                                |                                                                                         |                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>DIRECT</div> <div>Built for this.</div> <div>Who already serves it.</div> | <div>INDIRECT</div> <div>The workarounds.</div> <div>What they reach for instead.</div> | <div>ON THEIR OWN</div> <div>What they already do.</div> <div>When the moment comes.</div> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

# Go and look at the real field.

Try the options yourself. Use search or AI only to find the ones you missed.

- 01 Try them. Use the main options the way your user would.
- 02 Judge each one. Where does it work, and where does it fall short for someone in your user's situation?
- 03 Find the rest. Ask an AI or search for one thing only, the options you overlooked.

# Plot the field and read where you sit.

- 01 Pick your two axes. The two things your user really weighs, in their words.
- 02 Place every option, then place you. The existing options first, then where your idea sits among them.
- 03 Read your corner. Where you sit says how you help, compared to everything else.



# Name your position, then list what it rests on.

We give **your user** real help while asking **little of them**, where today's options **fall short**.

THEN LIST YOUR ASSUMPTIONS

Underneath, write the things you are believing but have not checked, about your user, your problem, and your idea.

POSITION NAMED • ASSUMPTIONS LISTED

# Take your assumptions out to be tested.

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THIS AFTERNOON • TEAM SYNTHESIS

## Bring it to your team.

Share what you mapped, where you sit, and the assumptions you are carrying. Decide together which ones matter most to check.

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TOMORROW • M2 VALIDATION

## Design the test.

On your own again, build a fair test for the assumption that matters most, one that could honestly come back no.